My Sanctuary

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/65647330.

Rating:
Teen And Up Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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F/F

Fandom:
She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Fluff, Canon, Post-Canon, Future Fic, Alternate Universe - Future, Mild Hurt/Comfort, Mild Angst, Catra is in Love with Adora (She-Ra), Adora is in Love with Catra (She-Ra), Adora Needs a Hug (She-Ra), Adora Needs Therapy (She-Ra), Partly inspired by Nate Stevenson's recent comic, Married Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Gardens & Gardening

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Part 49 of Adapted Prompts, Part 32 of Catradora: A Beautiful Wish

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by TheStarGayzingEtherianCollection (TheStarGayzingEtherian)

Summary

Catra wakes up one morning to find her wife isn't in their bed… and soon realises exactly where Adora has gone, to the one place in Brightmoon she can always feel safe. (Catradora, Canon, Fluff)

Notes

See the end of the work for notes

Catra didn't usually wake up this early in the mornings, not since she'd finally broken the strict routine her life had followed for years as a Horde officer. She'd finally learned how to relax and sleep in, knowing that life could go at whatever pace she wanted. But when she did wake up this early, there was one thing she always looked forward to, one that would fill the heart in her chest with warmth and glee.

As light streaked in through her window and a gentle morning breeze filled the air in the room, Catra stretched and wriggled a little, hoping to find the soft form of her beloved Adora resting next to her, knowing she would immediately bury her head into the blonde's chest, purr loudly and feel Adora's fingers thread through her long mane of hair, her soft voice whispering in her ear how much she loved her, as she would profess whenever she could.

"Mmmm... Morning Ador-" Catra's eyes widened when it was soon obvious to her that Adora wasn't in their bed. Instead next to Catra was a large empty space, the sheet already tossed aside. Catra panicked for a moment, wondering where her wife could be... before she focused her breathing, not letting her old worries get the better of her. Adora was probably still around... somewhere. She didn't have to fear Adora leaving her ever again, as the ring on her finger cemented.

Stretching again, Catra slumped out of her bed and put on her light purple dressing gown, hoping to track Adora down. As she left their room, she saw that much of the castle was still darkened. Barely anyone would be up at this hour of the morning, with the faint glow of sunlight filtering through the windows. Catra thought about maybe waking up Glimmer and Bow at least to give her a hand, but she figured the King and Queen needed their rest.

Besides, she already had a hunch where Adora might have gone. After all, this wasn't the first time the blonde had suddenly just... disappeared on her like this the last five years since the war had

ended. Poor Adora, even with everything she could ever want, she was still traumatised from the war, all the burden that being She-Ra had put on her. But Catra would always be at her wife's side.

But before acting on her hunch, Catra checked the library, the kitchen, even the rooftop terrace to see if Adora was there instead. But she was not. And thus, it was ninety-percent confirmed to Catra just where her wife currently was. She headed down to the vast and beautiful gardens behind the castle, remembering the route off by heart. She soon came to a small patch of trees where a golden gate waited for her, a gate that was always unlocked, but hidden in a remote part of the gardens, only known to a few.

Catra unlocked the gate and began to walk down the small winding path. It was as if she had entered a whole new place entirely, the path and the flowers surrounding it looking like something from a fairytale. She soon reached the end of the path and took in the view around her. She was in a secret hidden grotto off the side of the royal gardens, a place created just for Adora to go to whenever she felt overwhelmed or depressed and just needed to detach from the rest of the world for a while.

It had been a wedding present from Perfuma, who greatly understood the need for such a place, especially after Adora's first episode like this right after the war. That time, she'd run all the way off to hers and Catra's old spot in the Fright Zone. These days she was doing a lot better, but Catra knew that her wife's mental scars ran so deep, they would likely never be fully filled, something Catra herself knew all too well.

In taking this little grotto as her own, Adora had taken great care of it. All the flowers she had sprouted and nurtured using her She-Ra magic and her powers had also helped create the small pond at the center of the grotto, with a small golden statue of herself and Catra at the side of it, of them kissing at the Heart Of Etheria all those years ago. And standing before that statue, beneath the tallest tree in the grotto was Adora, her long blonde hair flowing in the wind much as her white nightgown was.

Slowly, Catra walked over to the blonde, who looked at her and greeted her with a small smile.

"Hi," she simply said.

"Hi," Catra replied back, standing near her. "Been here long? You weren't in bed when I woke up a bit ago."

"Not long," Adora answered, turning back to look at the statue and the pond before her.

Catra smirked. "You know, if you stand here all day, your legs are probably gonna hurt."

Adora chuckled, Catra's snarky jokes always making her smile. "I don't intend to be here all day, don't worry."

"Oh I know, and you can stay as long as you need to," Catra reassured her, walking behind her and wrapping her arms around her waist, resting her head on the blonde's shoulder. Adora sighed in content from Catra's touch.

"I'm sorry..." Adora whispered, Catra sensing the tiredness and weakness in her voice. "I know it's been a long time since I had to come here... and I was getting worried you might be disappointed in me..."

"Adora, you have nothing to be sorry for," Catra told her, before she noticed the grey bags under her eyes. "Stars, did you get any sleep last night?"

"Not... as much as I probably should have," Adora admitted. "I didn't have any bad dreams but just... it took me so long to get to sleep. Too much on my mind... Everything and nothing."

"You don't need to say any more, Princess." Her wife kept holding her tightly. "Just remember that those days of putting all that pressure on yourself, on being She-Ra, on being a hero... on being perfect for me are over now. You deserve to have a peaceful,

happy life... preferably one with a certain dashingly handsome prince like me."

Adora laughed again. Stars, Catra always knew just what to say. "And sometimes... I feel like you deserve better than me, better than a wife who constantly has moments where she feels worthless, that she hasn't got a purpose in life."

"I do have better, I have you. Oh sure, I probably could have been easily happy with Scorpia or Sparkles had fate gone a different way, but they don't compare to you."

Catra was obviously joking there, Adora knew that. She knew that she had always been the one for Catra and Catra likewise the one for her. For Adora, at this point, she had come to accept that her true destiny had been with Catra, not as She-Ra, the most powerful woman in the universe and hero to everyone. But even after all these years, there were still doubts, ones powerful enough to bring her down like this.

But Catra was helping her, healing her. In the few minutes since Catra had arrived, Adora was feeling like she could breathe again, that the great weight was finally off her shoulders once more. She pulled out of Catra's arms just a little so she could turn around and look her wife in the eyes. Her hands reached up and caressed the side of Catra's face, her fingers gently scritching behind her ears. A few soft little purrs from Catra and Adora was smitten all over again.

"I love you, Catra," Adora whispered, before she pulled Catra in and kissed her deeply. Catra wrapped her arms around her wife, feeling content that Adora was back to her old self again, kissing her back just as deep.

They parted from the kiss, Catra touching foreheads with her wife. "I love you more, Adora." She opened her eyes and smiled, stroking the blonde's cheek. "More than you could ever know."

"Well we are married, it would probably be weird if you didn't love me more than anything else," Adora teased.

Now it was Catra's turn to laugh, that adorable squeaky laugh that made Adora's heart flutter. "Oh you are just perfect Adora. Never let anyone tell you otherwise, even yourself. In fact, if I could, I'd somehow jump into your head and give those self-doubting thoughts a good butt-kicking."

"Awww," Adora blushed at her wife's devotion. "I don't deserve you."

"Yes you do," Catra replied, before pecking her on the lips again. "Now, feel like going back inside for some breakfast and then going for a nap together so you can catch up on your sleep?"

"That... sounds wonderful," Adora said fondly, as she let Catra take her hand and run back into the castle with her in tow. For Catra, it didn't matter what Adora did or how she felt these days. She was Adora, the woman she loved more than anything and that was all that mattered. And for Adora, she was reassured that no matter if she still had days when she'd feel depressed or anxious... She had been through the worst times of her life and the only thing in her future now was love and happiness, especially love from her beloved Catra.

End Notes

And last but not least tonight, a story based on a thread by Naz/AdoraLover on twitter. I took a few little liberties with the thread because I really wanted to make a few references to the She-Ra comic Nate Stevenson posted the other day. Hope you enjoy!

Based on a thread by Naz/AdoraLover

If you liked the fic please be sure to comment!

Please drop by the Archive and comment to let the creator know if you enjoyed their work!